Meter Replacement Policy

MetroGrid Utilities — Demonstration Knowledge Base | Owner: Customer Operations | Version: 3.2 | Status: Approved for Demo

Purpose and policy context

MetroGrid Utilities maintains a standard process for meter replacement to ensure that customer requests are handled consistently and that field teams receive sufficient information to assess the equipment. A replacement is treated as a service activity rather than an automatic response to every billing or consumption concern. The service representative is responsible for capturing the circumstances reported by the customer and applying the documented eligibility rules before routing the request.

Applicability

This policy applies to customer service representatives and operational teams handling residential and small-business metering equipment. It covers reports of physical damage, non-functioning displays, suspected meter malfunction and other conditions that require field assessment. It does not authorize employees to bypass technical inspection, electrical safety controls or approval requirements.

Customer-reported damage or malfunction

When a customer reports that a meter is damaged or not functioning, the representative should first establish the service account and location associated with the request. The meter identification number should be confirmed where it is available. The representative should capture the customer's description of the problem, including visible damage, a blank or unreadable display, unusual behavior, or other symptoms. A photograph may be retained when the service channel supports attachments and the customer can provide it safely.

Replacement eligibility

A replacement request may be appropriate when the available information indicates visible physical damage, a meter display that remains blank or unreadable after approved basic checks, a confirmed malfunction, or a field technician's determination that replacement is required. A customer's report of an unexpectedly high bill does not by itself establish that the meter should be replaced. Billing concerns should be handled through the applicable billing investigation process unless the meter issue is separately established.

Request preparation

Before a service request is submitted, the representative should ensure that the account number, service address, meter number where available, customer contact information and a clear description of the reported condition are recorded. Supporting evidence should be attached when applicable. Missing information should be obtained where practical rather than replaced with assumptions.

Workflow and responsibilities

Once the documented replacement criteria are satisfied and the required information has been captured, the representative may initiate the meter replacement or service request through the approved workflow. The request is then routed to the field operations queue. Field personnel inspect the equipment and determine the appropriate technical action. The service record should be updated with the inspection outcome and any subsequent action.

Safety and prohibited actions

Employees must not instruct customers to open, dismantle, bypass or tamper with a meter or electrical enclosure. If the reported condition involves sparks, fire, exposed electrical conductors, a downed line or another immediate hazard, the safety and emergency escalation process takes precedence over the normal meter-replacement workflow.

Related knowledge

Questions involving bill disputes should be considered with the Billing and Payment Procedure. Questions involving immediate electrical hazards should be considered with the Outage Management SOP and Electrical Safety Guidelines. Questions about how an agent records or escalates a case should be considered with the Customer Service SOP and Complaint and Escalation Matrix.

Demonstration document. This fictional content is intended for RAG evaluation and customer demonstration only. Replace with client-approved content before production use.

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